Dire Beginnings

Questbook D:
Demonrise

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Neverwake Manifestations

When an enemy group is outlined in purple in the questbook, it is accompanied by a Neverwake Manifestation. These enemies are referred to as Neverwake Enemies.

At the beginning of each adventure, shuffle the 11 Neverwake Manifestation cards.

When a group of Neverwake Enemies appears, draw a random Manifestation card unless the questbook specifies one. Assign that card to the enemy group in the same way as a Trait card.

The Manifestation and all of its effects remain in play until that enemy group is defeated.

Drucavia's Provinces & The Heroes' Journey

Whenever you commit to an adventure of this questbook that isn't the first (1D) or the last adventure (7D) in the series, you must choose in which province of Drucavia that adventure takes place.

Each region brings with it a unique complication that is active for that adventure, but also grants an additional reward after its completion.

Each province can only be chosen once per campaign run, and provinces cannot be chosen when playing the adventure of another questbook.

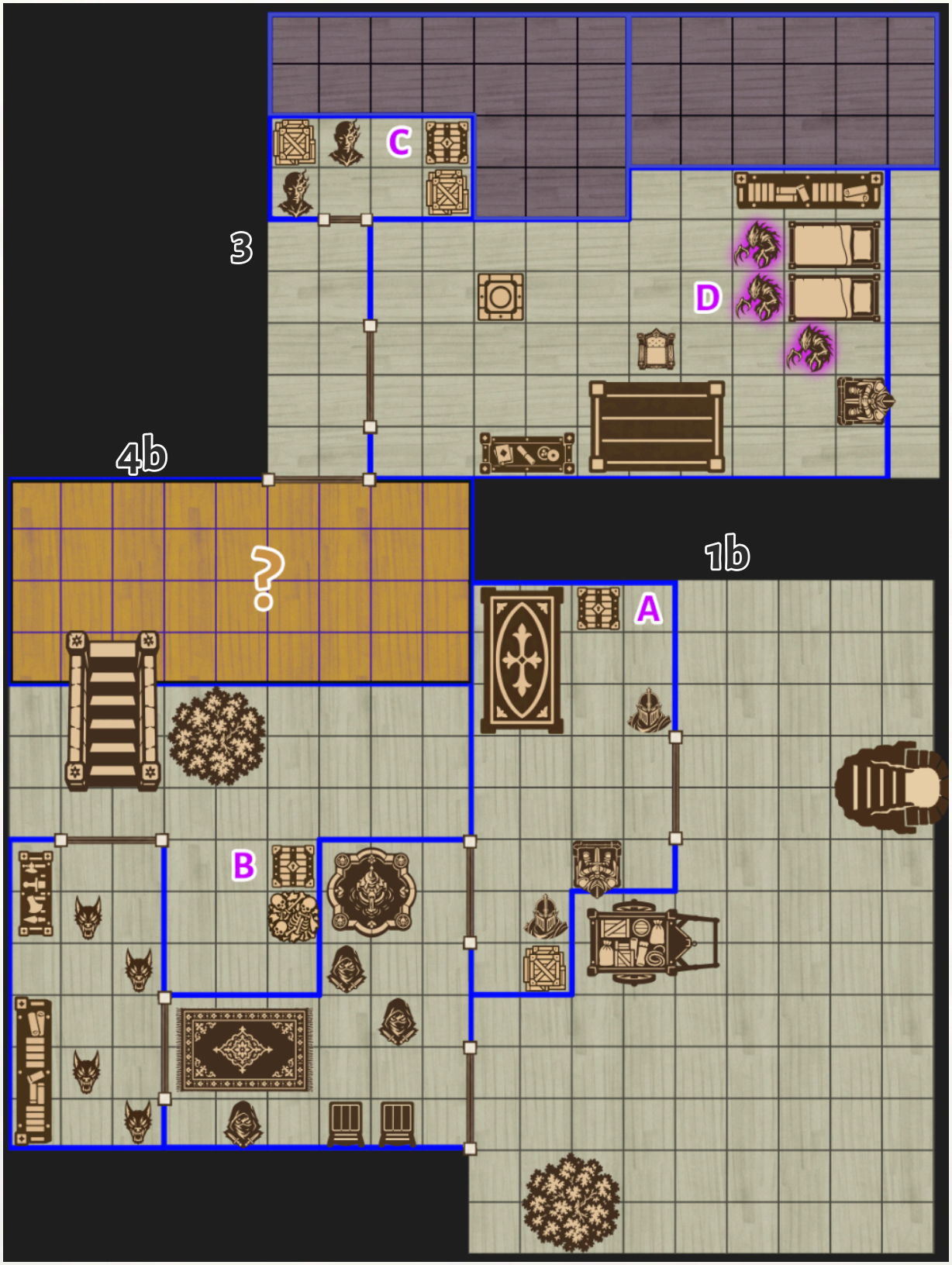
Find an overview of all rewards and complications below:

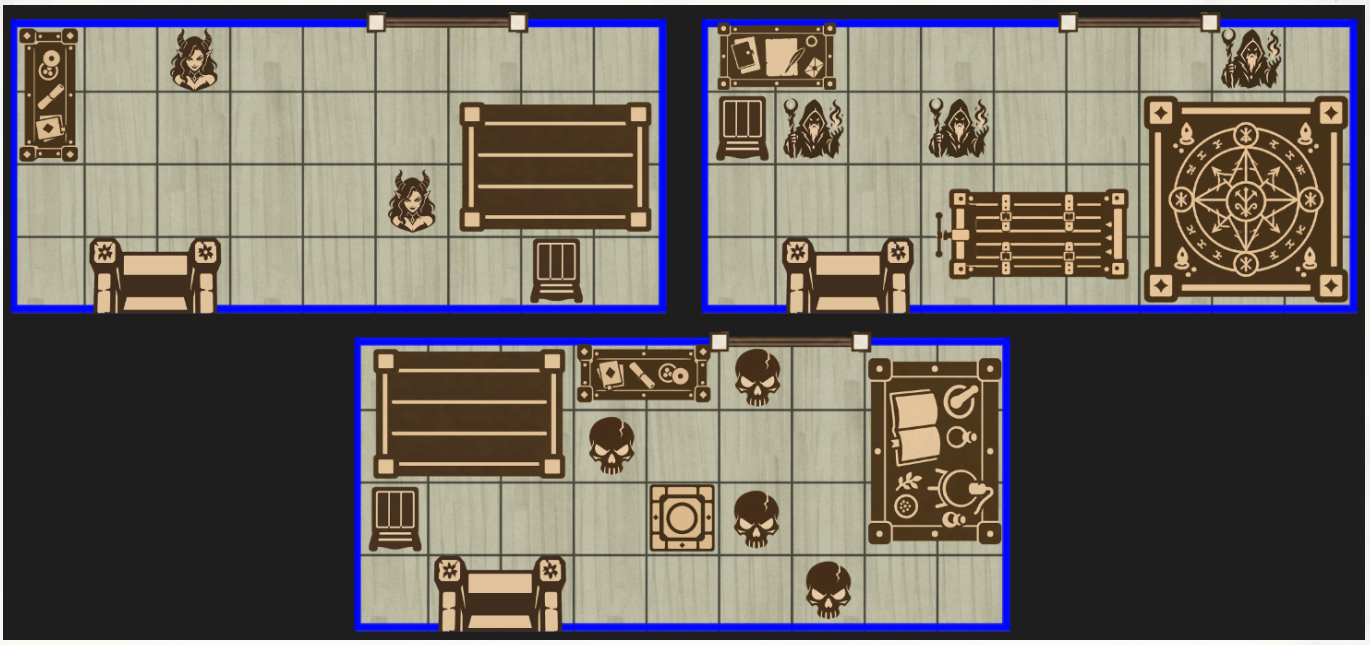
Region	Complication	One-Time Reward
Thornwater	At the beginning of each round, **spawn 1 x Corrupted** at the dungeon entrance or starting area. *This marks people of Thornwater who succumbed to the control of the Neverwake and are swarming in.*	Gain **45** gold coins.
Grimhaven	*Grimhaven has become a magnet for thieves and scammers.* At the beginning of the adventure, the party must mark one of its items with a **coin value of 25+ as stolen**. It cannot be used during the adventure, but guards will return it next town phase.	Gain an **Epic affix** of your choice.
Ashen Vale	*A shadowy expanse has cast itself across the region.* Line of Sight is limited to a range of **4** spaces for **every** model..	**Ashen Boots:** One hero may ignore difficult terrain for the remainder of the campaign, and gains +1 Speed. *
Crownmoor	*Crossing the steep mountains comes with a feeling of fatigue that is unmatched.* Heroes have **-1 Stamina maximum** for this adventure.	Heroes start all adventures with **2 Stamina**.
Eastweald	Whenever an enemy dies, roll a d6. On a 5+, place a **tree** prop covering its position. If that tree would make it impossible for any models to reach other rooms, place it on the closest viable position instead. Skip spawning if 2 trees already exist.	**Strategic Maps:** twice per adventure, any one hero may **Rush** at any time. *
Blackwold	*The area is shrouded.* Whenever enemies are revealed, roll a d6. On a 4+, these enemies are only placed on the board as soon as it's their first turn.	**Occult Books:** one hero may force an enemy to discard a Neverwake Manifestation and gain a new one. Do so when it spawns. This costs 1 Fatigue. *
Briarfen	*The terrain is swampy.* All heroes have **-1 speed**.	**Plant Stimulants:** All heroes suffer only half the Fatigue from non-lethal attacks (after toughness checks, rounded up). *
Hallowmarch	All enemies (except bosses) gain the **Zombies trait**.	**Priestly Tome:** one hero gains +1d6 to spellcasting for all spells that can heal. *

** These special items are represented through item cards found in the Demonrise unlock box.*

Adventure 1D: The Sleeping Hero

Starting Doom Clock: 8
Resurrection Boons: 2





Intro

For weeks, Sir Garran Of Sunkirst, one of King Arnewald's most trusted champions, has failed to report from the eastern reaches of Drucavia. Their telepathic link has gone silent. Every pigeon sent to his estate has failed to return.

King Arnewald rests both hands upon the war table.
"Garran has served me longer than most men at this court. If he could answer me, he would."
He points toward the Ashen Vale.
"I sent him there to investigate strange sightings and missing travelers. Whatever he found, I fear it found him first." Then the King looks up.
"I need him for what lies ahead. Find him. Bring him home."

Days later, Garran's castle appears beyond the hills.
No guards man the walls. No servants cross the courtyard.
The small village before the keep is equally still. Doors hang open. Carts stand abandoned. Not even the dogs come to greet you.

Objective

Find the sleeping hero, and slay his captors.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	Doom Clock at 2+ upon completion	5	100
★★	Doom Clock at 1+ upon completion	5	80
★	Adventure completed	4	70

Adventure Overview

- A -

The treasure chest contains 25 gold coins.

- B -

The treasure chest contains a Relic: Old Shield (Warding, Fencer's).

- C -

The treasure chest contains a tome that grants one hero of the party's choice +1 XP after the adventure concludes.

- D -

Read the following text aloud:

At the center of the chamber lies Sir Garran Of Sunkirst, on his bed. Alive. Unwounded. Asleep.
Shadowy figures crouch around him. Thin strands of darkness drift from Garran into their barely solid forms, as though each breath feeds them. Then one twists its head toward you.
The others follow and their pale eyes open. You feel as if the chamber groans.

The far wall suddenly slides away. Stone tiles stretch beneath your feet. Pillars drift apart, and Garran seems impossibly distant despite no one having moved. The creatures rise.
Whatever this room once was, it no longer obeys the dimensions of the castle.

Assign the enemies in this room the **"The Long Hall" neverwake manifestation** card. They do not get a random manifestation card in addition. The adventure ends once they are defeated.

Outro

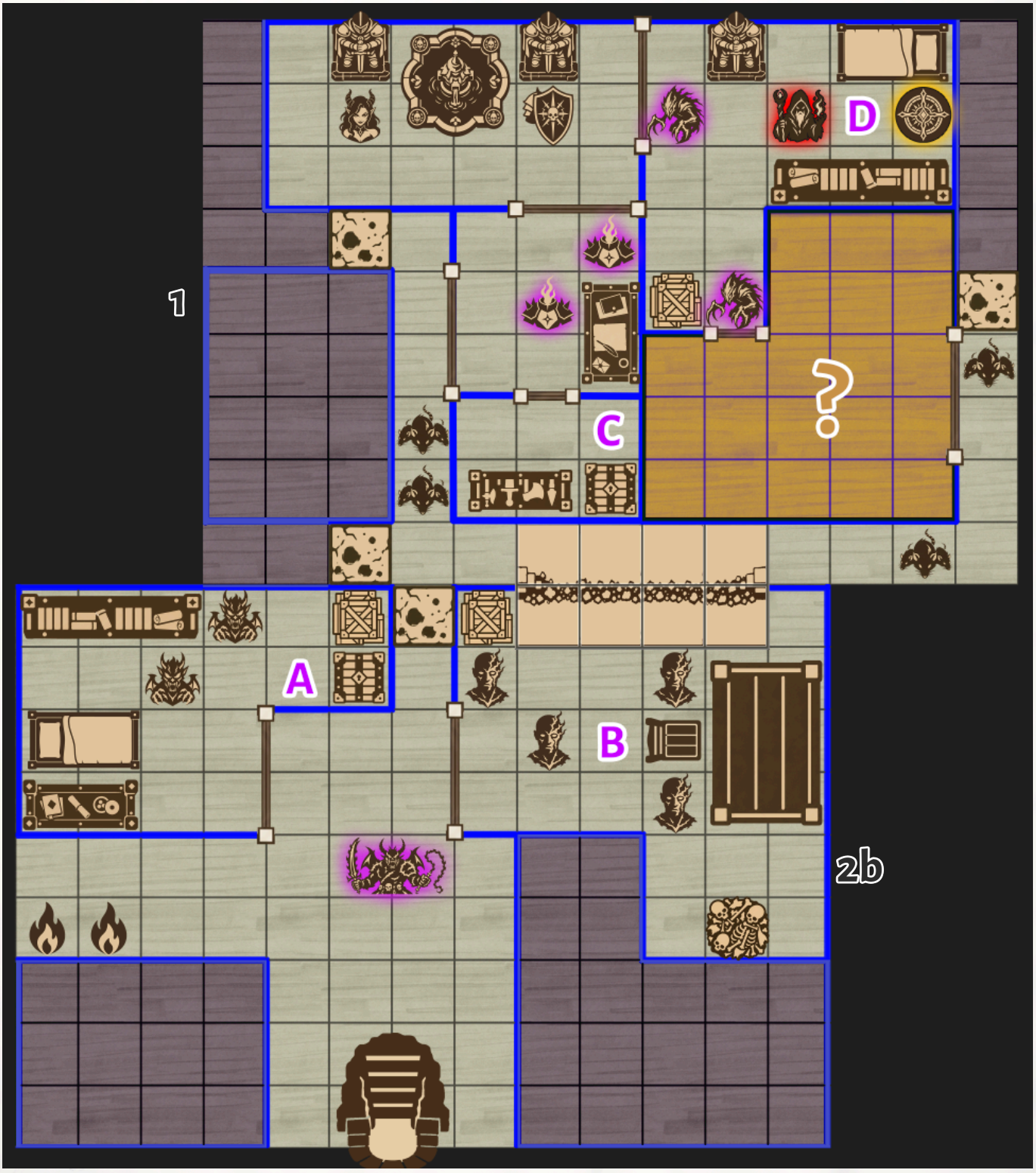
Sir Garran returns to Thornwater alive, but he does not wake.

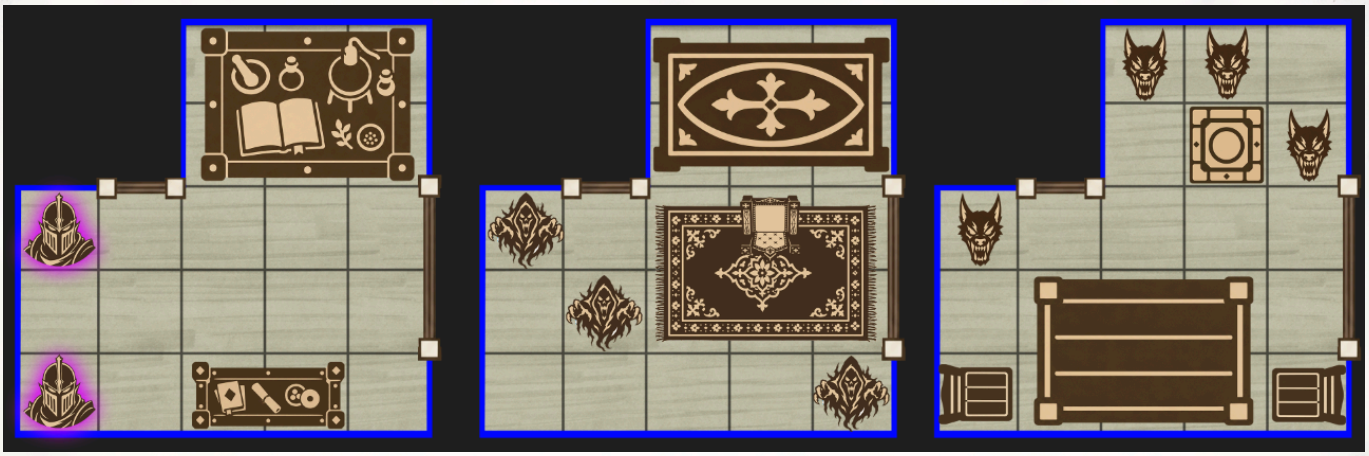
Physicians, priests and scholars all fail to rouse him. At last, King Arnewald stands beside his champion's bed while Sitilius Morcant completes his examination.
"Well?" the King asks.
"He is healthy. His mind is still present."
"Then wake him."
Sitilius hesitates. "I cannot."
The King stares at him. Then Sitilius continues:
"I found no curse, poison or enchantment. Nothing I recognize is holding him."
Arnewald looks back toward Garran. "So he simply fell asleep?"
Sitilius slowly shakes his head. "No. I think he went somewhere."

Outside, the bells of Thornwater mark the evening hour. Sir Garran does not stir.
And already, reports of others who will not wake are beginning to reach the capital.

Adventure 2D: The Dreamer's Daughter

Starting Doom Clock: 8
Resurrection Boons: 1





Intro

Two nights later, Sitilius Morcant sends word for you to meet him away from the palace.
He waits in a shuttered chamber above an old apothecary, his expression unusually tense.
"The King does not know I called you here." Sitilius lowers his voice.
"Sir Garran has a daughter. Talia. Twelve years old, and touched by a kind of magic I have never properly understood. I have taught her what little conventional sorcery she would listen to, but there has always been something else beneath it." He pauses for a moment.
"When I examined Garran, I felt traces of that same strangeness."
Sitilius quickly raises a hand.
"I am not accusing the girl. And until I know more, I will not give Arnewald reason to fear her."
He unfolds a weathered map across the table and points to a secluded place beyond Thornwater.
"Talia vanished shortly after her father stopped responding. If she is hiding, I believe this is where she went."
He looks to each of you.
"Find her. Bring her back alive. And whatever you discover there, tell me before you tell the King."

Objective

Find Talia Of Sunkirst, and save her if necessary.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	Doom Clock at 2+ upon completion	5	130
★★	Doom Clock at 1+ upon completion	4	120
★	Adventure completed	3	110

Adventure Overview

- A -

The treasure chest contains a **random Level 1 item**. Draw items from the item pile until you reveal a Level 1 item, and take that as your reward. You may skip consumables and items worth 10 gold coins or less.

- B -

When entering this room, read the following aloud:

This room looks less abandoned than you expected it to be.
Blankets have been dragged into one corner, beside empty food wrappings, cracked jars and the remains of a small fire. Someone has been living here for some time, making do with whatever they could find.
On a nearby table, however, the clutter changes. Sheets of paper are covered in hurried notes, copied runes and rough arcane diagrams. Several pages have been crossed out and rewritten again and again.
Whoever sheltered here was not merely hiding. They were studying.

- C -

The treasure chest contains 20 gold coins.

- D -

The objective token should be replaced with Talia's standee. She is a minion with **20 Health, 0 Speed, an armor value of 5+ and no attack** as she is frightened and exhausted. The entire campaign is lost when she dies.
The adventure ends when all remaining enemies are defeated.
The Evil Wizard in this room is a **boss**. Use the following reference table:

Property	Description / Value
Health	35
Defense	4+
Speed	4
Attacks	1
Damage	7
Range	-
Passives	Immune to **Daze**.
Traits	Legendary, Sorcerous, Counter Attack
Minor Ability	**Destabilize Talia:** The Evil Wizard gains a Neverwake Manifestation at the beginning of the round. Discard it at the end of the round.
Major Ability	***Neverwake Magic*** At the end of his turns, roll 1d6 and execute an ability based on the roll. **1-2: Nightmare Bolts** All heroes and minions within Range 5 suffer an attack with 5 Damage. **3-4: Twisted Reality** Each hero swaps their available abilities with the abilities in their discard pile. Banished abilities are unaffected. Then each hero must banish 1 card or lose 3 health. **5-6: Neverwake Apparition** Creates one Wraith as close as possible to him which gains a Neverwake Manifestation. It acts in that same round based on its AI card.

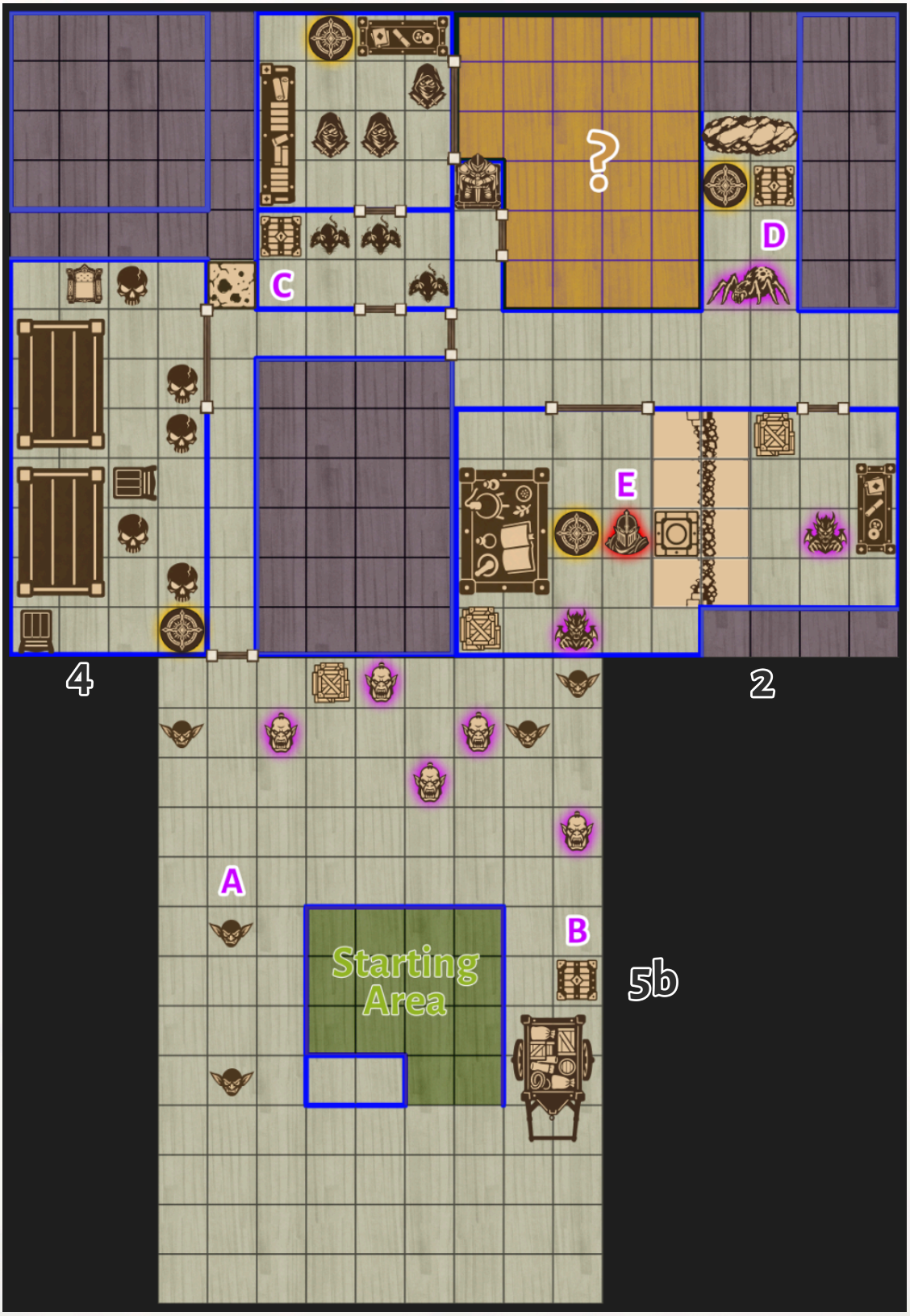
Outro

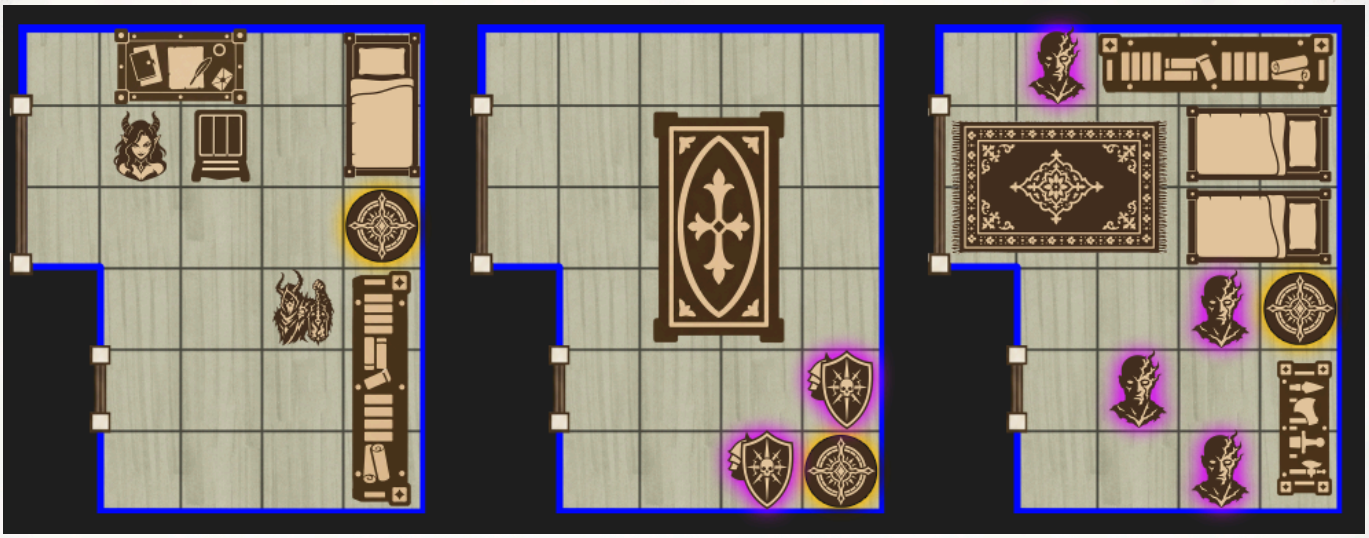
When the last creature falls, one of you kneels beside Talia.
She is shaken, scraped and exhausted, but otherwise unharmed. Someone gives her water, and another wraps a cloak around her shoulders. For a moment, nobody asks her anything.
Eventually, Talia notices the sigil of the king's court upon your armor. "You came from Thornwater?"
One of you nods. Then she hesitates. "Do you know about my father? Did he wake up?"
When you tell her he has not, Talia looks away. "I thought so."

For a while she says nothing. Then:
"Strange things started happening whenever I used my magic. It felt different. Like there was something pulling at it from somewhere far away." She stares at the floor.
"And people started falling asleep."
Talia tells you about one of them. She had watched a pale creature crouch over the sleeper and draw something glowing from their body, a tiny shard of light, before carrying it away.
"I thought I imagined it at first. But I could feel it leave." A worried silence follows. Then Talia looks toward the dark road beyond the ruins.
"I can still feel them. The pieces they took." She points into the distance.
"I think I know where they went."

Adventure 3D: Stolen Dreams

Starting Doom Clock: 7
Resurrection Boons: 1





Intro

After you bring Talia back to Sitilius, he insists on examining her himself.
He checks her pulse, her eyes, and the flow of magic around her hands.
Talia endures the whole thing with visible impatience. "I'm fine."
"You were hiding alone in a ruin surrounded by things from somewhere I cannot name," Sitilius replies.
"Permit me a little caution." At last, he lowers his hands.
"No curse. No possession. Nothing I can detect that should stop you from travelling."
Talia folds her arms. "Good. Because I can still feel them."
The heroes exchange a glance. Sitilius looks less convinced.
"And you are certain this sensation leads somewhere?"
Talia nods. "It gets stronger when I face the right direction. Like a thread being pulled tight."
Sitilius is silent for a moment, then looks to the heroes. "Do not let her out of your sight."

By morning, you leave the city behind. Talia guides you across old roads, muddy fields and forgotten paths, sometimes walking confidently, sometimes stopping for several minutes with her eyes closed before changing direction. By dusk, the road has disappeared entirely.
Ahead stands a ruined waystation beneath a sky already turning grim.
Talia stops. "It's here."

Objective

Discover what the demons are up to, and disrupt their operations.

Starting Conditions

Heroes and initial minions, like Talia, can be placed anywhere in the starting area.
Before starting, determine which hero controls Talia.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	4+ Soul Shards collected.	5	140
★★	2+ Soul Shards collected.	5	120
★	Adventure completed	4	110

Special Mechanic - Talia Of Sunkirst

During this adventure, Talia Of Sunkirst follows the party as a minion — decide which hero controls her. She has **6 Health**, **5+ Armor**, **6 Speed** and **2d8 Offense at Range 5**. She dies in the same fashion as a hero: place a fallen hero token, and you may revive her with a Resurrection Boon or when reaching the town phase. Instead of performing an attack, she can allow an adjacent hero to **Regain** one ability.
Due to her child-like nature, she can force an enemy to ignore her as a viable target once per round.

Special Mechanic - Soul Shards

Objective tokens depicted in this adventure showcase a stash of Soul Shards. Once a room is discovered with Soul Shards in it, they are carried away by minor demons at the end of that round, making the objective token disappear. A hero adjacent to one can collect it by spending 1 Stamina, increasing the count of collected Soul Shards by 1. These are relevant to determine the adventure rewards.

Adventure Overview

- A -

The goblins in this room gain the **Ranged trait**.

- B -

The treasure chest contains random contents. Roll 1d6:

1-2: 20 gold coins
3-4: Draw from the item pile until you reveal 3 Consumables.
Gain all three Consumables, then shuffle all other revealed cards back into the pile.
5-6: Warhammer or 50 gold coins.

- C -

The treasure chest contains a Relic: Dabbler's Band (Runescribed, Spellbound).

- D -

The treasure chest contains random contents. Roll 1d6:

1-2: A trap! The hero loses 4 health or must banish one ability (choose).
3-4: A random **Epic** affix. Draw from the pile at random until you reveal an Epic affix.
Then apply it to any one item among the party.
5-6: A tome that grants one hero +1 to any one of their ability limits for the rest of the campaign (e.g. Arcane, Combat etc.). Choose the recipient and category during the town phase.

- E -

When entering this room, read the following text aloud:
The chamber beyond resembles an alchemist's workshop, though its instruments are unlike anything you recognize. Glass vessels, brass frames and strange apparatus crowd the tables.

At their center stands a hooded figure. He holds a glowing shard delicately between two fingers, turning it beneath the light as though studying a gemstone.
Then the Soulwright notices you. His gaze passes over the heroes and settles on Talia.
For a moment, he simply stares. "So. The little dreamer followed the thread."
Talia stiffens. "Do I know you?"
The Soulwright gives a quiet laugh and places the shard carefully upon the table. "Not yet."
He reaches beneath his cloak. "But the road remembers you."
Around the chamber, the strange apparatus begins to hum. The Soulwright prepares to fight.

The enemy marked as a Fallen Hero is the Soulwright. Place Talia within Range 3 of him now.
He is a **bespoke boss** with the following phase:

Phase 1
Injuring Stab, Soul Reflection, Dreamscaping, Soulblast

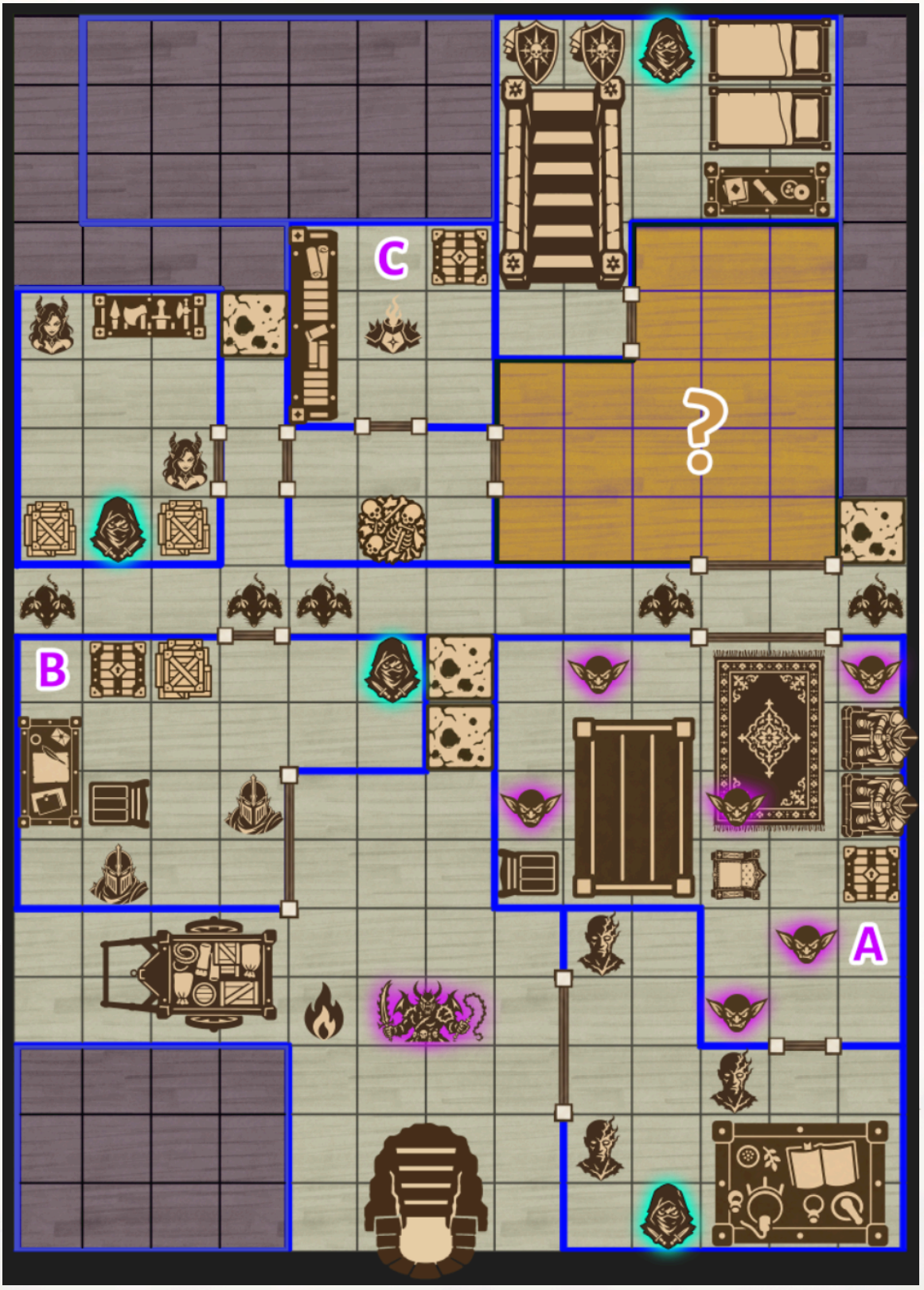
The adventure ends as soon as he is defeated.

Outro
The Soulwright staggers, but does not fall.
Instead, he thrusts one hand forward. Darkness folds open behind him, forming a narrow tear in the air.
"Another time, little dreamer." Before anyone can reach him, he steps through. The tear snaps shut.

Several glowing shards remain scattered across the chamber.
Later, you return to Thornwater with Talia, the recovered shards and several peasants who remain asleep.
Sitilius spends hours examining them. At last, he turns from one of the motionless victims.
"They are alive. Their bodies are unharmed. Their minds are still there."
He lifts one of the glowing fragments. "But something has been taken from them."
Talia watches the shard in his hand. "That's what I felt." She closes her eyes.
After a moment, she turns toward the window. "And I can still feel the others."
Her finger traces a direction beyond Thornwater. "He went that way."

Adventure 4D: The Sleeping Hold

Starting Doom Clock: 6
Resurrection Boons: 1



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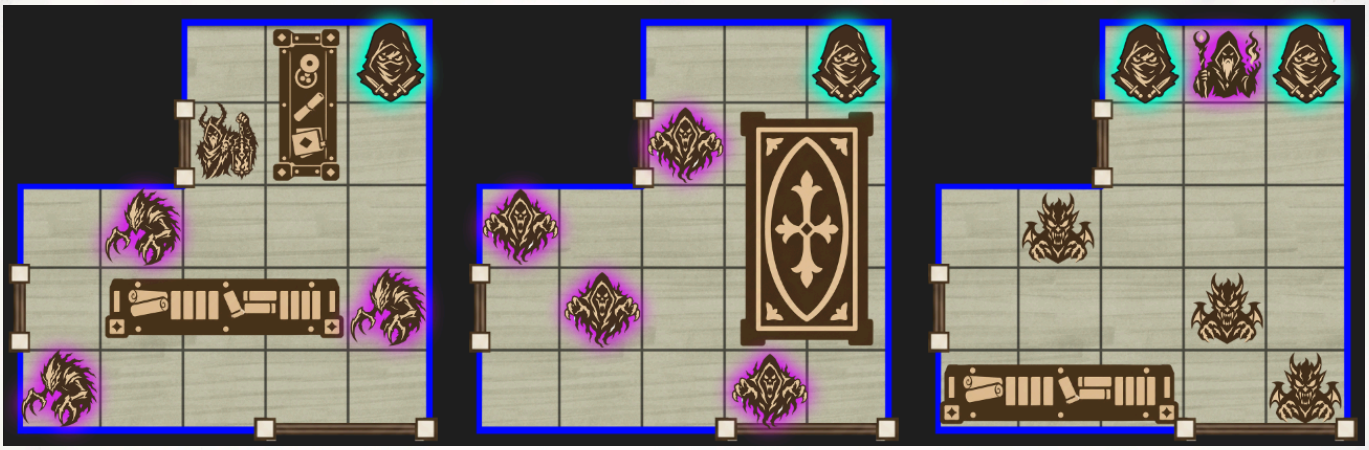


Intro

Talia leads you away from the king's court, following the same uneasy pull that brought you to the Soulwright before. By one late afternoon, the trail ends at an old castle overlooking a half-abandoned village. Its gates stand open, but no guards answer your approach.
Inside, you find one of the few people still alive and awake. The survivor is exhausted, terrified and barely willing to speak above a whisper. "They came in groups. Not soldiers... worse. Demons. They took people room by room."
He points deeper into the castle.
"They don't kill them. They put them to sleep. Then they take something from them. Crystals. Glowing things."
Talia goes pale. "The shards."
The survivor nods quickly. "There was a hooded one here too. The others listened to him. But he left before dawn."

Again, the Soulwright has slipped through your grasp. From somewhere deeper in the castle comes a distant scream. The survivor looks toward the sound.
"There are still people alive in there."
You draw your weapons. The Soulwright may be gone, but his work is not.

Objective

Rescue as many Survivors as possible before the Doom Clock reaches zero.
The adventure fails if no Survivors are rescued.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	4+ Survivors rescued.	5	170
★★	2+ Survivors rescued.	5	150
★	1 Survivor rescued.	4	135

Special Mechanic - Talia Of Sunkirst

During this adventure, Talia Of Sunkirst follows the party as a minion — decide which hero controls her. She has **6 Health**, **5+ Armor**, **6 Speed** and **2d8 Offense at Range 5**. She dies in the same fashion as a hero: place a fallen hero token, and you may revive her with a Resurrection Boon or when reaching the town phase. Instead of performing an attack, she can allow an adjacent hero to **Regain** one ability.

Due to her child-like nature, she can force an enemy to ignore her as a viable target once per round.

Special Mechanic - Survivors

Bandits in the questbook marked with a teal-colored outline are Survivors. At the beginning of the adventure, choose one hero to control all Survivors discovered during that adventure.
When a Survivor is discovered in a room, it immediately becomes a Minion under that hero's control. Use a Bandit or Peasant standee to represent it.
Each Survivor has **7 Health**, **5 Speed**, and may attack with **2d8 Offense** at **Range 5**, representing a basic crossbow. For the round in which a Survivor is revealed, it also has **4+ Armor**.

A Survivor is rescued if they were discovered during the adventure and are still alive when the adventure ends. It automatically ends once the Doom Clock reaches zero.

Adventure Overview

- A -

The treasure chest contains the former belongings of this castle's lord.
Obtain either a Decorated Plate Armor **or** a Royalist Greatsword.
The item bears the family crest and can never be sold — it is expected to be returned once your duty is complete, at the end of this campaign.
Whichever item you choose, add one **Mythic** or **Epic** affix of your choice to it.

- B -

The treasure chest contains random contents. Roll 1d6:

1-2: 20 gold coins
3-4: Obtain a tome that grants one hero +1 to any one of their ability limits for the rest of the campaign (e.g. Arcane, Combat etc.). Choose the recipient and category during town phase.
5-6: Obtain a random **Mythic** affix. Draw from the pile until it shows a **Mythic** affix. You may then apply it to any item in the party's possession.

- C -

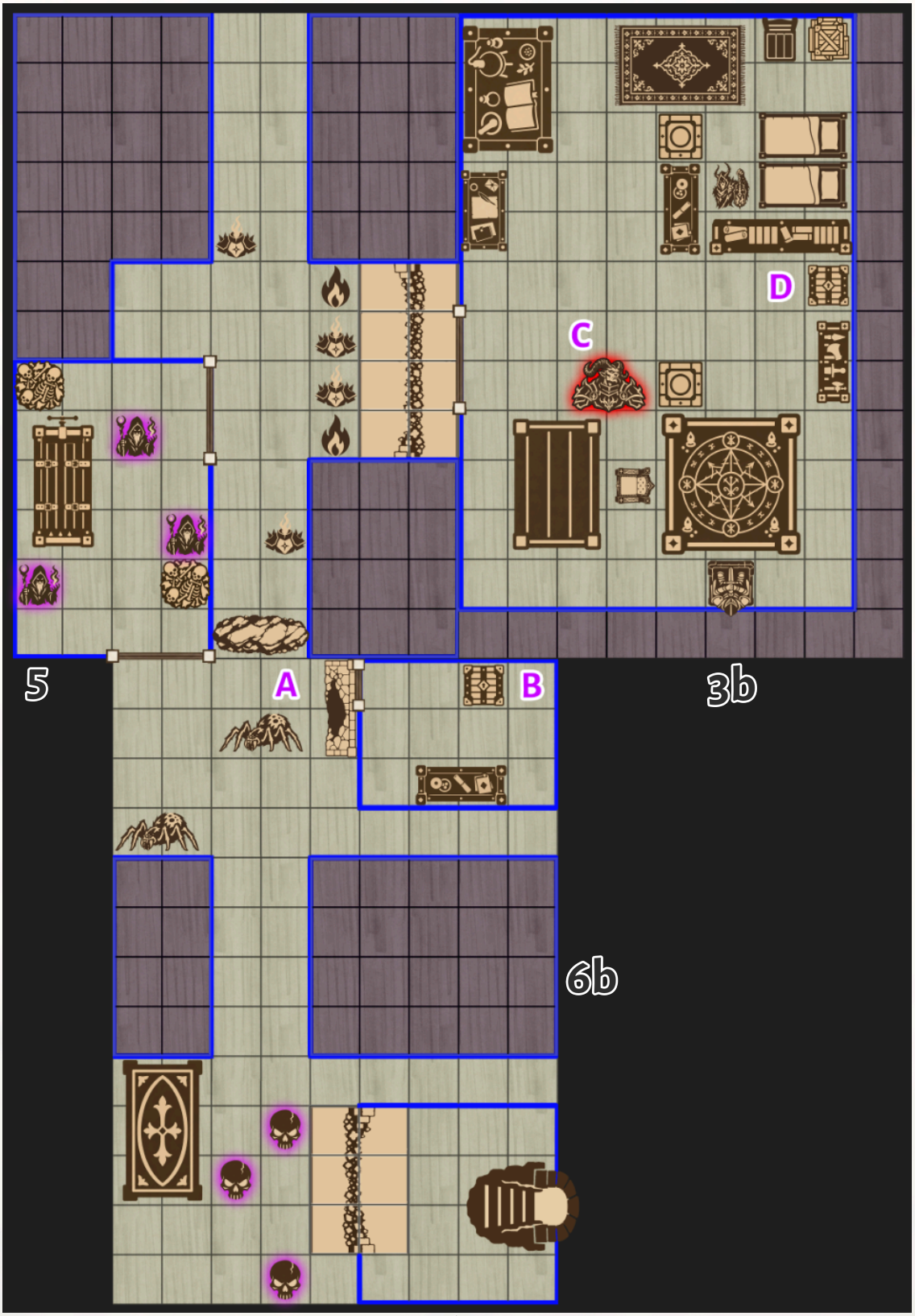
The treasure chest contains a power focus. During the next town phase, one hero permanently gains an additional trait slot (type: flex) for the remainder of the campaign.

Outro

With the last of the demon lieutenants slain, the castle finally falls quiet.
Some remaining villagers emerge cautiously from their hiding places. Around them, dozens still lie trapped in unnatural sleep. Among the villagers, one man remembers something.
"The hooded one wasn't alone when he came here."
Another survivor nods. "He spoke with some kind of commander. Bigger than the others. Armored."
They explain that the commander seemed to be directing more than just this castle. Other villages were mentioned. Other groups. Other collections.
Whatever happened here was only one part of something much larger.
The Soulwright has escaped you twice now. Talia looks frustrated, but one of you voices the obvious.
Perhaps it is time to stop chasing the one who runs. And start hunting the one who gives the orders.

Adventure 5D: Removing Command

Starting Doom Clock: 9
Resurrection Boons: 2



Intro

Back in Thornwater, Sitilius has news.
Agents of the court have traced the demon commander to a remote keep beyond the eastern road.
"If he truly coordinates these operations, he may know where the Soulwright is going next."
Then he turns to Talia. "You are staying here."
Talia immediately shakes her head. "No."
"Talia, this is not another ruin full of scavengers. This creature commands them."
She hesitates, then looks at the heroes.
"I've been trying something. The place my magic comes from... the Neverwake. I can reach further into it. I think I can use it to help."
Sitilius' expression hardens. "Absolutely not."
Talia folds her arms. "I'm old enough to decide that myself. And unless Father somehow made you my regent, I don't have to listen to you."
Sitilius stares at her for a long moment, then exhales. As you prepare to leave, he pulls one of you aside.
"Keep her safe. And if she reaches into that place again..."
He glances toward Talia. "Watch carefully what reaches back."

Objective

Kill Ghalar the Demon Commander.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	Doom Clock at 3+ upon completion	6	160
★★	Doom Clock at 1+ upon completion	5	155
★	Adventure completed	5	140

Special Mechanic - Talia Of Sunkirst & Neverwake Magic

During this adventure, Talia Of Sunkirst follows the party as a minion — decide which hero controls her. She has **6 Health**, **5+ Armor**, **6 Speed** and **2d8 Offense at Range 5**. She dies in the same fashion as a hero: place a fallen hero token, and you may revive her with a Resurrection Boon or when reaching the town phase. Instead of performing an attack, she can use her **Neverwake Magic**:
Shuffle the five Neverwake Magic cards into a face-down pile. When she uses this magic, draw the topmost card and resolve it. If the pile is empty, reshuffle it again.
Due to her child-like nature, she can force an enemy to ignore her as a viable target once per round.

Adventure Overview

- A -

A hero who is standing adjacent to the broken wall can spend 1 Stamina and roll 2d6.
They add +1d6 for each Strength trait slot they have. If they have at least 1 success against 4+, remove the broken wall prop and open the door behind it.
If the hero fails, they suffer the "Broken Shoulder" injury.
If that injury is already in play, they lose 3 health instead.

- B -

The treasure chest contains a random **Epic** affix.
Draw from the pile of affixes until you have two **Epic** affixes, then choose one.
Apply it to an item of the party's choice.

- C -

Read the following text aloud:
The chamber doors open onto a war room strewn with maps, weapons and the remains of some hurried council.
At its center stands the demon commander.
His gaze passes over the heroes, then stops on Talia. For a moment, his expression changes. Recognition.
Then he smiles. "There you are."
Talia grips her weapon tighter. The demon spreads his arms.
"Thank you, little dreamer." His smile widens.
"There was no road before you dreamed one."
Talia freezes. The commander draws his weapon.
"And now we walk it freely."

This enemy is Ghalar the Demon Commander. **Place Talia within Range 5 of him now.**
He is a **bespoke boss** with the following phases:

Phase 1

Chain Pull, Charge, Halberd Strike

Phase 2

Conjure Demons, Charge, Halberd Strike, Flailing Strike
Add **Crushing Strike** when playing at **campaign difficulty 5+**.

The adventure ends as soon as he is defeated.

- D -

The treasure chest contains a Relic: Memory Stone (Refreshing).

Outro

The demon commander lies dead, but his words linger. Talia barely speaks on the journey back to Thornwater.
When Sitilius finally finds her, he does not press her at first.
"What did he mean?" he asks quietly. Talia stares at the floor. For a long moment, she says nothing.
Then she begins. She tells you that her strange magic did not always frighten her.
At first, reaching into it felt beautiful. Vast. Impossible. Like looking into a world made entirely from dreams.
So she kept going. She experimented. Reached deeper. And eventually, she saw something there.
Something ancient.
Something enormous.
Something sleeping.

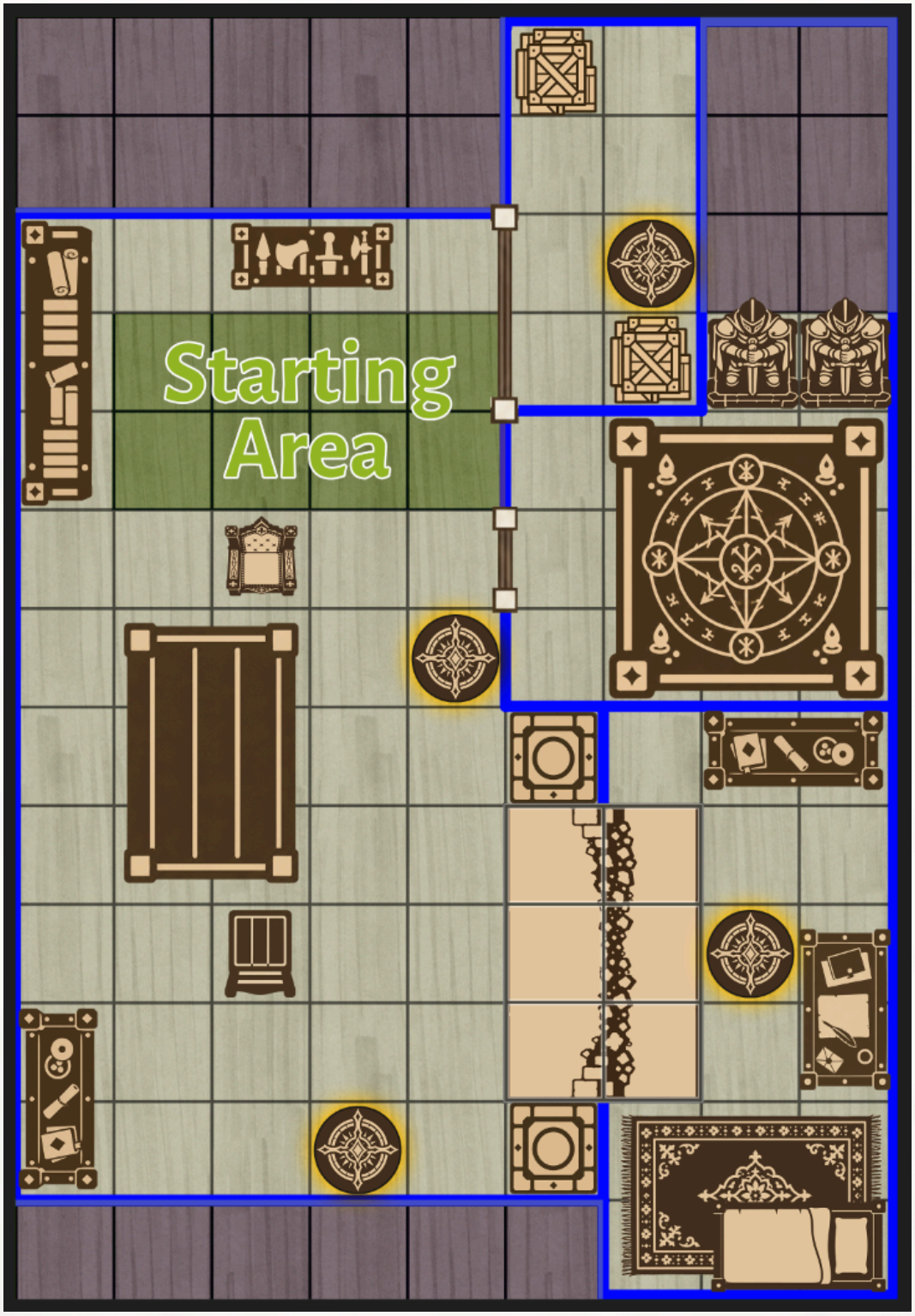
"I didn't know what it was. I thought I was only looking." Her voice grows quieter.
"Then Father fell asleep." Talia explains that she tried everything she could to wake him. Nothing worked.
She panicked. Then others began falling asleep as well, and the creatures appeared.

“I thought maybe it was because of me.” She finally looks up. “Now I think I was right.”
Sitilius kneels beside her.
“Opening a door you did not understand is not the same as knowing what waited behind it.”
Talia says nothing. Then, after a moment: “Maybe not.”
She looks toward the darkened window.
“But if I opened it, then I have to help close it.”
Sitilius’ expression tightens. “Even if it kills you?”
Talia does not answer. She does not need to.

Adventure 6D: Trapping a Demon

Starting Doom Clock: 8
Resurrection Boons: 1

3



Intro

Sitilius spends days examining the maps and correspondence recovered from the demon commander. Eventually, he discovers a pattern.
"The Soulwright returns to this place repeatedly. An old mansion, abandoned for decades. If we arrive before him, we may finally catch him."

Inside the mansion, you discover an enormous collection of glowing soul shards, carefully arranged in strange vessels and arcane apparatus. Hundreds of them.
You prepare an ambush and wait.

Hours later, a black shadow slips through a broken window. It swirls through the chamber before taking the familiar shape of the hooded Soulwright. He notices you immediately, yet makes no attempt to escape.
"How persistent you are."
Talia steps forward, her wand raised: "Tell us what you've done. What is happening to all those people?"
The Soulwright regards her quietly.
"Still asking questions, little dreamer? You have come so far, yet understand so little."
He glances toward the countless glowing shards.
"It hardly matters now. Soon, the Neverwake Dragon's first Avatar will walk this world."
"Not if I can stop it!" Talia cries. Before the Soulwright can answer, a violent surge of magic erupts from her wand.

The battle begins.

Objective

Kill the Soulwright.

Starting Conditions

Heroes and initial minions, like Talia, can be placed anywhere in the starting area.
Before starting, determine which hero controls Talia.

Then place the Soulwright anywhere within Range 3 of Talia.

All doors are **open** from the beginning.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	Doom Clock at 3+ upon completion	6	200
★★	Doom Clock at 1+ upon completion	6	180
★	Adventure completed	5	170

Special Mechanic - Ambush Traps

Your heroes prepared for this ambush. The objective tokens represent traps that can be used against the Soulwright and his minions. Models can stand on traps and draw Line Of Sight over them.

A trap can either be activated by spending 1 Stamina while being within Range 2 of it, or by dealing at least 1 point of damage to it (e.g. with an attack or spell).

When a trap gets triggered, choose which type it was, resolve its effects, then remove that objective token:

Explosive Barrel:	Causes Blast 4.
Poison Darts:	Causes Decay 8 to any one enemy within Range 3 of the trap.
Sanctified Wards:	Put a Weave token next to an enemy within Range 3 of the trap. That enemy's damage (of all attacks and abilities) is halved. At the end of its turn, remove the Weave token.
Loud Explosives:	All heroes, minions and enemies within Range 3 of the trap suffer Stun and Daze.

Special Mechanic - The Soulwright

The Soulwright is a **bespoke boss**.

He has three phases with the following boss abilities:

Phase 1

Soul Reflection*, Mayhem, Injuring Strike

Phase 2

Soul Reflection*, Conjure Demons, Dreamscaping

Phase 3

Conjure Demons, Soulblast, Combo
Add **Flailing Strike** when playing at **campaign difficulty 5+**.

* For this ability, the party is assumed to have collected **3 Soul Shards**.

Special Mechanic - Talia Of Sunkirst & Neverwake Magic

During this adventure, Talia Of Sunkirst follows the party as a minion — decide which hero controls her. She has **6 Health**, **5+ Armor**, **6 Speed** and **2d8 Offense at Range 5**. She dies in the same fashion as a hero: place a fallen hero token, and you may revive her with a Resurrection Boon or when reaching the town phase. Instead of performing an attack, she can use her **Neverwake Magic**:
Shuffle the five Neverwake Magic cards into a face-down pile. When she uses this magic, draw the topmost card and resolve it. If the pile is empty, reshuffle it again.
Due to her child-like nature, she can force an enemy to ignore her as a viable target once per round.

Outro

The Soulwright collapses, his robes darkening with blood. An hourglass slips from his belt and strikes the stone floor. It shatters.

Suddenly, every soul shard in the chamber begins to glow. The vessels crack, and hundreds of fragments rise into the air. Outside, a violent vortex forms above the mansion. The shards rush through the broken windows, spiraling upward into a sky that begins to tear apart.

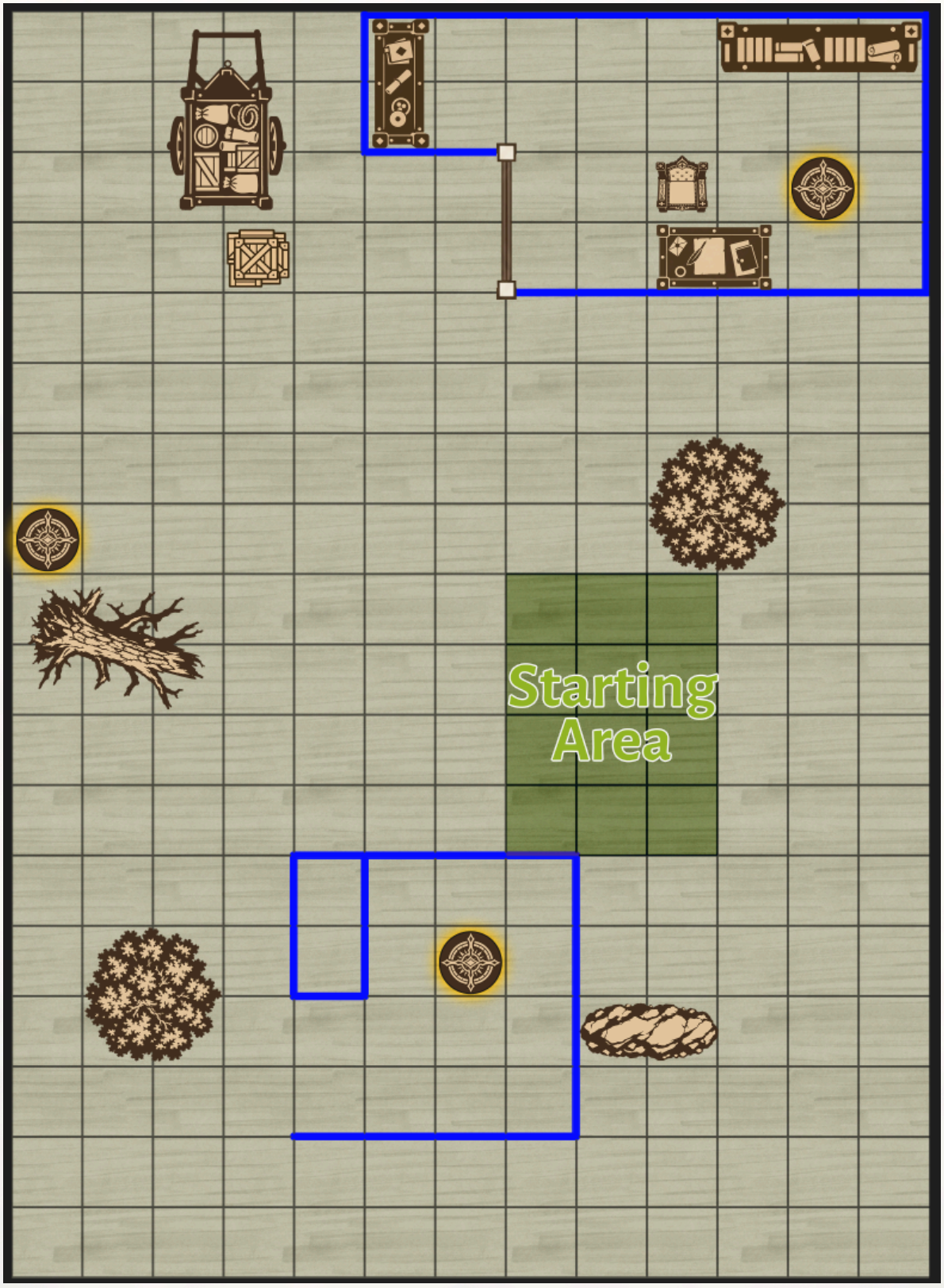
The Soulwright exhales one final, panicked breath.
“It wasn't meant to happen yet...”

Talia watches in horror as the last shards disappear into the growing rift.
“We have to stop this!” You rush outside, where the sky itself is splitting open.

Adventure 7D: The Avatar

Starting Doom Clock: 8
Resurrection Boons: 2

1b

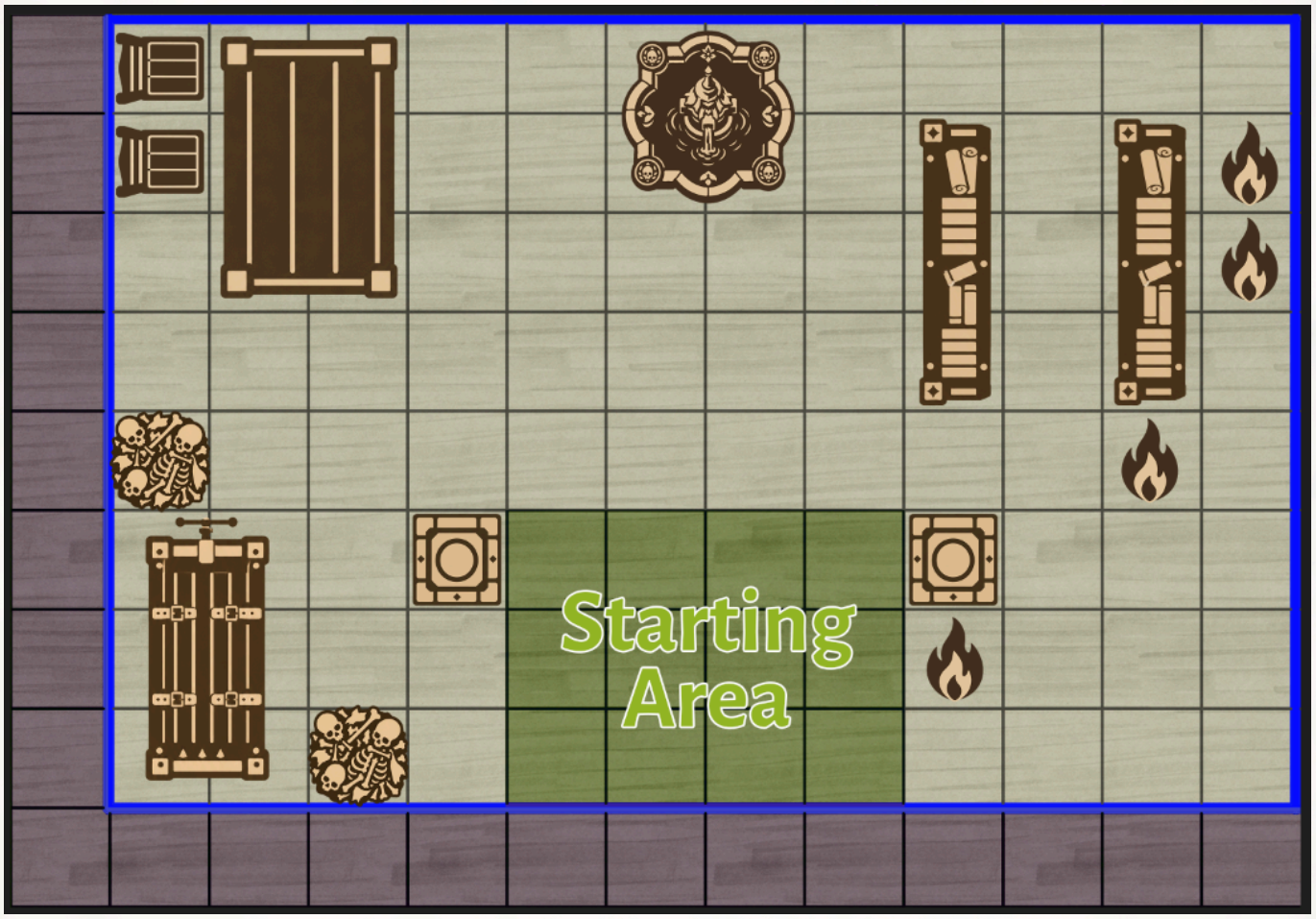


5b

Neverwake Realm (Arena)

Only enter this space as part of the "Neverwake Tether" Special Mechanic.

3b



Intro

You rush outside the mansion. Above you, the vortex tears across the sky, its center pulsing with unnatural light.

Suddenly, enormous anchors of some dreamlike, translucent material fall from the heavens, crashing into the earth around you. Great chains stretch from them into the swirling darkness above.

Something is descending. A gigantic demonic creature glides down one of the chains. Its body is a shifting mass of dark magic, barely holding a recognizable shape. Within its chest, an enormous purple heart pulses with terrible energy.

The creature looks around, seemingly confused by its surroundings. Then its gaze settles upon you and Talia. It roars with blind fury. Yet something about it is wrong. Parts of its body flicker and dissolve, only to reform moments later. Whatever this creature is, it has entered your world before it was ready.

Talia grips her wand. "I can feel it. It's still connected to the Neverwake. That's what's holding it here." She looks up at the vortex, then at the chains.

"I think I can get through. Into the Neverwake itself. If I break the connection from the other side, it won't be able to draw on all that power."

She pauses, her voice suddenly smaller. "But I don't think I can come back."
The creature roars again, shaking the ground beneath your feet.
Talia looks to you, waiting for your decision.

Decision A: Allow For Her Sacrifice

[This decision will significantly weaken the bespoke boss of this adventure]

You give Talia your answer. She takes a trembling breath, then nods.
"Alright. I can do this."

She approaches one of the fallen anchors and raises her wand. Before casting, she turns back to you.
"Thank you. For coming to find me. For everything."

She smiles, though there are tears in her eyes. Then she strikes the anchor with her magic.
Lightning races along its surface. Talia's body begins to glow, her form dissolving into a brilliant stream of energy. For one fleeting moment, you can still recognize the young girl within the light.

Then she surges upward, racing along the chain toward the heavens. The vortex swallows her. Far above, a blinding flash tears through the darkness. The Avatar convulses, its purple heart flickering violently.

Talia has reached the other side. Now it is your turn.

Decision B: Keep Her By Your Side

[This decision will unlock a secret reward if you survive this adventure]

One of you steps beside Talia and gently lowers her wand.
"No. We came here to stop this thing, not to lose you."
Talia looks up, startled. "But I opened the way! If I don't do something..."
"You didn't choose what came through. And you don't have to face it alone."
For a moment, Talia struggles to find an answer.

Then she looks at the monstrous creature before you. Her frightened expression slowly gives way to determination. "Then we'll do it together."
She raises her wand again, this time toward the Avatar. Magic gathers around its tip.
"Let's send it back where it came from."

Objective

Kill the Avatar.

Starting Conditions

Heroes and initial minions, like Talia, can be placed anywhere in the starting area - Talia only participates if **Decision B** "Keep Her By Your Side" was chosen. In this case, determine which hero controls Talia.

Then place the boss, the Avatar, anywhere on the board.

The one door is initially open.

Rewards

Stars	Requirement	XP Reward	Gold Reward
★★★	No hero died during the adventure. *	-	-
★★	No more than 1 hero died during the adventure. *	-	-
★	Adventure completed.	-	-

* Talia's deaths (should she participate) do not count towards this.

This adventure grants no rewards, as the campaign ends and the heroes retire afterwards.
Star results are only relevant for the Legacy Sheet.
Remember the one-time star bonus upon completing the campaign equal to difficulty x 3.

Special Mechanic - The Avatar

The Avatar is a **bespoke boss**.

It has three phases with the following boss abilities:

Phase 1

Neverwake Tether, Unstable Nature, Dream Clone, Backfire Curse

Phase 2

Neverwake Tether, Unstable Nature, Dreamscaping, Backfire Curse, Flailing Strike

Phase 3

Neverwake Tether, Matter of Nightmares, Enforced Pact, Charge
Add **Crushing Strike** when playing at **campaign difficulty 3+**.
Add **Injuring Stab** when playing at **campaign difficulty 6+**.

As an **exception**, the Avatar only proceeds to the next phase when ***all*** abilities of the current phase have been banished, not when there is one card remaining.

If Talia sacrificed herself (**Decision A** "Allow For Her Sacrifice" was chosen during the intro), the party may do the following a total of **3 times** during this adventure:

- **Talia's Intervention:** After the boss executes an ability as part of its regular end-of-turn execution, the party may immediately Banish this ability. It will not be executed as a reaction. This may even target "Neverwake Tether".

Special Mechanic - Neverwake Tethers

The Avatar is manifested through three anchors, the Neverwake Tethers.
Each of them is represented by an objective token.

The boss' ability "Neverwake Tether" cannot be banished when wounding it. If the boss is wounded and it is the last ability, the boss remains at 1 Health until the ability is removed either through Talia's intervention (see above - only possible as part of her sacrifice), or by clearing out the Neverwake Realm of enemies (see below).

To remove it, a hero has to briefly enter a shallow pocket of the Neverwake Realm. Upon walking onto an objective token, the hero repositions to the starting position of the Neverwake Realm. Then spawn a number of enemies within it based on the current phase - these are always **Neverwake enemies**, but they are only spawned for the first hero entering the space during a given boss phase:

Phase 1 3 x Beast
Phase 2 3 x Living Armor
Phase 3 1 x Rift Herald (with the **Enduring** trait) + 1 x Succubus

These enemies may be placed anywhere in the designated arena space.

Once all enemies are killed, do these steps:

1. Return all heroes currently in the Neverwake Realm back to become adjacent to the objective token they entered through.
2. Remove the "Neverwake Tether" ability from the boss' draw or discard pile, without executing it as a bonus reaction.
    a. If that was the last ability of the current phase, the Avatar enters its next phase (or dies if it was the last one), and heals back to full.
3. Remove the objective token the heroes just came back through.

Heroes can only enter the Neverwake Realm if the boss still has the "Neverwake Tether" ability in the deck of the current phase (either in the draw or discard pile).

Special Mechanic - Talia Of Sunkirst & Neverwake Magic

During this adventure, Talia Of Sunkirst follows the party as a minion **only** if "Decision B" was chosen — if that is the case, decide which hero controls her.
She has **7 Health**, **5+ Armor**, **6 Speed** and **3d8 Offense at Range 5**. She dies in the same fashion as a hero: place a fallen hero token, and you may revive her with a Resurrection Boon or when reaching the town phase. Instead of performing an attack, she can use her **Neverwake Magic**:
Shuffle the five Neverwake Magic cards into a face-down pile. When she uses this magic, draw the topmost card and resolve it. If the pile is empty, reshuffle it again.
Due to her child-like nature, she can force an enemy to ignore her as a viable target once per round.

Outro

With a final, terrible scream, the Avatar shatters.

Its enormous heart bursts, and hundreds of soul shards erupt from its disintegrating body, falling like pale rain across the battlefield. But their light is gone.

The fragments strike the earth, dull and lifeless. Whatever souls they once contained have been consumed to give the Avatar its form. The vortex collapses. The chains dissolve, and the sky slowly returns to normal.

You have prevented something terrible from entering your world. Yet hundreds of innocent lives have been lost. And across Drucavia, countless others remain trapped in their unnatural sleep.

Days later, King Arnewald gathers you and Sitilius at his court.
The King listens grimly to your account. At last, he speaks.
"We shall call this new phenomenon the Eternal Slumber. And we shall find a cure. Every physician, priest and scholar in Drucavia will have whatever they need."
Sitilius nods, though he offers little reassurance.

Then Arnewald turns to the court mage.
"And this Neverwake Dragon? The creature the Soulwright spoke of. What do we know?"
Sitilius produces several ancient books recovered from the royal archives.
"Very little, Your Majesty. Most accounts contradict one another. Some describe an ancient being that dreams beyond our reality. Others speak of entire realms shaped by its slumber."

He opens one of the oldest volumes. His eyes move across the faded writing.
Then he stops.
Arnewald notices his expression. "Sitilius?!"
The mage slowly closes the book, his face pale.
*"Your Majesty... the Soulwright called what we fought the Dragon's **first** Avatar."*
For a moment, nobody speaks.

Outside the palace windows, the sun sets over Thornwater.
And somewhere beyond the waking world, the Neverwake Dragon continues to dream.

Campaign End + Secret Unlock + Court Teacher Unlock

You have finished this campaign. Tally your star rewards and spend them on the Legacy Sheet to enhance future playthroughs.

Additionally, if this is the first time you have defeated the Avatar, unlock the **Court Teacher** for all future playthroughs.

From now on, during each Town Phase, the party may use the **Court Teacher's** services once at any point. When using the Court Teacher, designate one hero. That hero draws 2 traits and 3 abilities only they may look at. They can learn any of those as if they were in the corresponding displays. Additionally, the first of those cards is discounted and costs 1 XP less, to a minimum of 0.

Secret Reward

If Decision B was chosen during the intro and Talia didn't sacrifice herself, open the secret reward bag.
You have unlocked a new, special hero that can be used during all future playthroughs.
This hero **cannot** be played during any adventures of this questbook should you repeat it.